

Pre-Flight Diabetes Checklist

Travelling the World with Type 1 Diabetes | tomhbird.github.io

BEFORE YOU LEAVE THE UK

- Book appointment with GP and diabetes team
- Request travel supply of insulin at least a month before you go. Your GP should provide around three months of supply.
- Order CGM sensors and consumables well in advance
- Get a signed letter from your GP confirming your diagnosis and medication
- Apply for translated medical ID cards for non-English speaking countries
- Purchase travel insurance that explicitly covers Type 1 diabetes
- Declare your full diabetes history to your insurer

PACKING

- Short acting insulin
- Long acting insulin

If visiting a reciprocal healthcare agreement country (such as Australia or New Zealand), bring at least three months of supply. If visiting a country without an agreement, bring enough to cover your entire trip.

- Needles and pen caps
- CGM sensors and transmitter
- Backup finger prick meter and test strips
- Glucose tablets or fast acting sugar
- Frio cooling bag
- Rigid case and ziplock bag for insulin storage
- Sharps disposal container
- GP letter and medical documentation
- Translated medical ID card
- Copies of all prescriptions

AT THE AIRPORT

- Keep all insulin and devices in hand luggage, never the hold
- Allow 30 extra minutes at security
- Have GP letter and medical ID card accessible

ON THE ROAD

- Set a 48 hour reminder to air out your Frio bag
- Never leave insulin in a hot car
- Check blood sugar more frequently when diet changes
- Identify local pharmacies and hospitals on arrival in each country
- Plan your long acting insulin timing adjustment before you fly. Speak to your diabetes team about managing significant time zone shifts.

COUNTRY SPECIFIC GUIDANCE

For food guides, insulin access ratings, CGM availability and healthcare deal information for each country, visit the interactive route and country guide at tomhbird.github.io/map

For links to NDSS, Medicare, Diabetes UK, travel insurance comparison tools and translated ID card services, see the Resources section of the article at tomhbird.github.io